

Hotel Guest Messaging SOP

Standard Operating Procedure — Guest Communication

Complete each section of this template to create a working guest messaging SOP for your property. A finished SOP gives any team member or external support partner enough context to handle guest communications consistently, on brand, and within your defined escalation rules.

Section 1 — Property Information

Property name: _____	Property type (hotel / STR / resort): _____
General Manager / Owner: _____	Primary reservations contact: _____
After-hours escalation contact: _____	After-hours contact number: _____
PMS in use: _____	Channel manager / OTA tools: _____
SOP owner (who maintains this document): _____	Last reviewed / updated: _____

Section 2 — Channels Covered Under This SOP

Check all channels included in this SOP.

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Inbound phone — main line | ☐ Inbound phone — reservations line |
| ☐ SMS / text messages | ☐ WhatsApp Business |
| ☐ Email — reservations@ | ☐ Email — info@ / general |
| ☐ Booking.com Message Center | ☐ Expedia Partner Central inbox |
| ☐ Airbnb messages | ☐ Vrbo messages |
| ☐ In-app (PMS guest messaging) | ☐ Other: _____ |

Section 3 — Response Time Targets

CHANNEL	RESPONSE TARGET	HOURS COVERED	RESPONSIBLE
Inbound calls	_____	_____	_____
SMS	_____	_____	_____
WhatsApp	_____	_____	_____
Booking.com inbox	_____	_____	_____

CHANNEL	RESPONSE TARGET	HOURS COVERED	RESPONSIBLE
Expedia inbox			
Airbnb / Vrbo			
Email			

Section 4 — Brand Voice Guidelines

Tone (circle one):

☐ Formal

☐ Warm-professional

☐ Casual-friendly

Property name used in messages (e.g. 'The Langford' vs 'we'):

Languages spoken / supported:

Standard phone greeting script:

Standard message sign-off:

Words or phrases to avoid:

Topics that must always be escalated (never answered directly):

EXAMPLE MESSAGES (paste 2–3 real examples from your property)

Example 1 — reservation inquiry response:

Example 2 — late checkout response:

Example 3 — complaint response:

Section 5 — Scenario Handling Guide

SCENARIO	HANDLE DIRECTLY?	ESCALATE TO	NOTES / SCRIPT
Rate and availability inquiry			
Booking modification (within policy)			
Cancellation (within policy)			
Cancellation (outside policy)			
Late checkout request			
Early check-in request			
Rate negotiation / discount			
Group inquiry (5+ rooms)			

SCENARIO	HANDLE DIRECTLY?	ESCALATE TO	NOTES / SCRIPT
Complaint — minor	_____	_____	_____
Complaint — serious / media	_____	_____	_____
Maintenance issue — non-urgent	_____	_____	_____
Maintenance emergency	_____	_____	_____
Medical / safety emergency	_____	_____	_____
Special occasion / upgrade request	_____	_____	_____
Lost property	_____	_____	_____
Review / feedback question	_____	_____	_____

Section 6 — Escalation Matrix

SITUATION	ESCALATE TO	METHOD	RESPONSE EXPECTED
Medical / safety emergency	Call 911, then notify management	_____	Immediate
Maintenance emergency	Call / SMS	_____	< 30 min
Serious guest complaint	_____	_____	_____
Rate dispute / refund request	_____	_____	_____
Media / press inquiry	_____	_____	_____
PMS / system access issue	_____	_____	_____
Other: _____	_____	_____	_____

Section 7 — Logging and Reporting

Define what gets logged and how reporting works.

Log location (shared sheet / PMS / email): _____

Who reviews the log: _____

Reporting frequency: _____

Morning summary delivered to: _____

Morning summary delivered by (time): _____

Each log entry should include:

- ☐ Date and time
- ☐ Caller / guest name
- ☐ Issue type
- ☐ Outcome
- ☐ Channel (call / SMS / OTA / email)
- ☐ Contact number or platform ID
- ☐ Action taken
- ☐ Escalation triggered? (Y/N)

☐ Escalation contact notified

☐ Resolution status

Section 8 — SOP Maintenance

- ☐ This SOP is reviewed and updated at least quarterly.
- ☐ Rate changes, policy updates, and seasonal procedures trigger an immediate SOP update.
- ☐ New team members and external partners read this SOP before handling any guest communication.
- ☐ SOP updates are communicated to all active handlers before they take effect.

Need a team to work inside this SOP for your property?

GuestSquad agents are briefed on your SOP before handling any guest interaction. guestsquad.com/contact